

Summary

Simone Facchiano is a PhD student in Artificial Intelligence at Sapienza University of Rome. Simone is currently a Visiting Researcher at the Max Planck Institute for Informatics, in the Department of Computer Vision and Machine Learning headed by Bernt Schiele. His research focuses on interpretability and controllability of **Flow Matching for image and video generation**. He is the first author of peer-reviewed publications in these areas.

Simone earned his Bachelor's degree in **Statistics** with honors (110 cum laude), followed by a Master's degree in **Data Science**, where he graduated with honors (110 cum laude) with the title of Honor Student. For his merits, Sapienza University awarded him the title of "**Outstanding Graduate**" for ranking among the top 1% of graduates in 2026.

Ph.D. Activity

- **Ph.D. in Artificial Intelligence** [ROME] *November 2024 – Present*
 - PhD student of the National PhD Program in Artificial Intelligence, supervised by Prof. Fabio Galasso and Prof. Emanuele Rodolà.
 - First author of "Video Unlearning via Low-Rank Refusal Vector" at ICLR 2026 (in collaboration with NVIDIA).
 - First author of "Steering Fields: Adaptive Vector Fields for Safe Image Generation and Beyond" (Facchiano S., Lenssen J.E., Schiele B., Stammer W., Galasso F., Fischer J.) and co-first author of "Not All Latent Spaces Are Flat: Hyperbolic Concept Control" (Briglia M.R.*, Facchiano S.*, Cursi P.*, Sampieri A., D'Amely G., Franco L., Galasso F., Masi I.). Both papers are currently under review.
 - Lecturer and Teaching Assistant for the courses of *Fundamentals of Data Science* and *Advanced Machine Learning*.

Working Experience

- **Visiting Researcher at Max Planck Institute** [SAARBRUCKEN] *March 2026 – Present*
 - Visiting Researcher at the Department of Computer Vision and Machine Learning, working with Bernt Schiele, Jonas Fischer, and Jan Eric Lenssen on Flow Matching for image generation and editing, with state-of-the-art results on safety steering for text-to-image (T2I) generation. Paper under review at an A* conference.
- **Intern for Master's Thesis at CINECA** [ROMA] *March 2024 – October 2024*
 - Internship for master's thesis titled "Llama for User Support: Developing a Large Language Model as a Ticketing System". This work involved extensive use of the Leonardo supercomputer, providing hands-on experience with large-scale HPC workflows. The thesis was awarded the highest grade.

Honors and Awards

- Outstanding Graduate at Sapienza University of Rome for ranking among the top 1% of graduates in 2026.
- Honors Student in the M.Sc. in Data Science at Sapienza University of Rome.
- Recognized for academic merit through inclusion in the Sapienza University's merit list for academic years 2020-2021, 2021-2022, 2022-2023.
- Awarded the Certificate of Merit issued by the *Associazione Nazionale Carabinieri* in 2023.
- Winner of the Amazon Web Service (AWS) Training Camp Jam Session in 2023 in Sapienza University.
- Winner and team leader of the Statistical Learning 2023 Hackathon in Sapienza University of Rome.

Education

- **Master's Degree in Data Science** [ROME, MAASTRICHT] *September 2022 – October 2024*
 - Graduated with honors (110 cum laude) with a GPA of 29.68/30, the highest of my cohort.
 - Selected for the university's **Honours Program**, conducting research on State Space Models for video generation.
 - Erasmus exchange at **Maastricht University** during the 2023 winter semester.
 - *Tutor of Statistical Inference* for the Bachelor's program in Management Statistics at Sapienza University.
- **Bachelor's Degree in Management Statistics** [ROME] *September 2019 – July 2022*
 - Graduated with honors (110 cum laude), completing a data-driven thesis on "Access to Food in Cambodia, Myanmar, and Vietnam" with data provided by the World Bank.
 - Awarded the Certificate of Merit by the National Association of Carabinieri for "outstanding academic achievements".